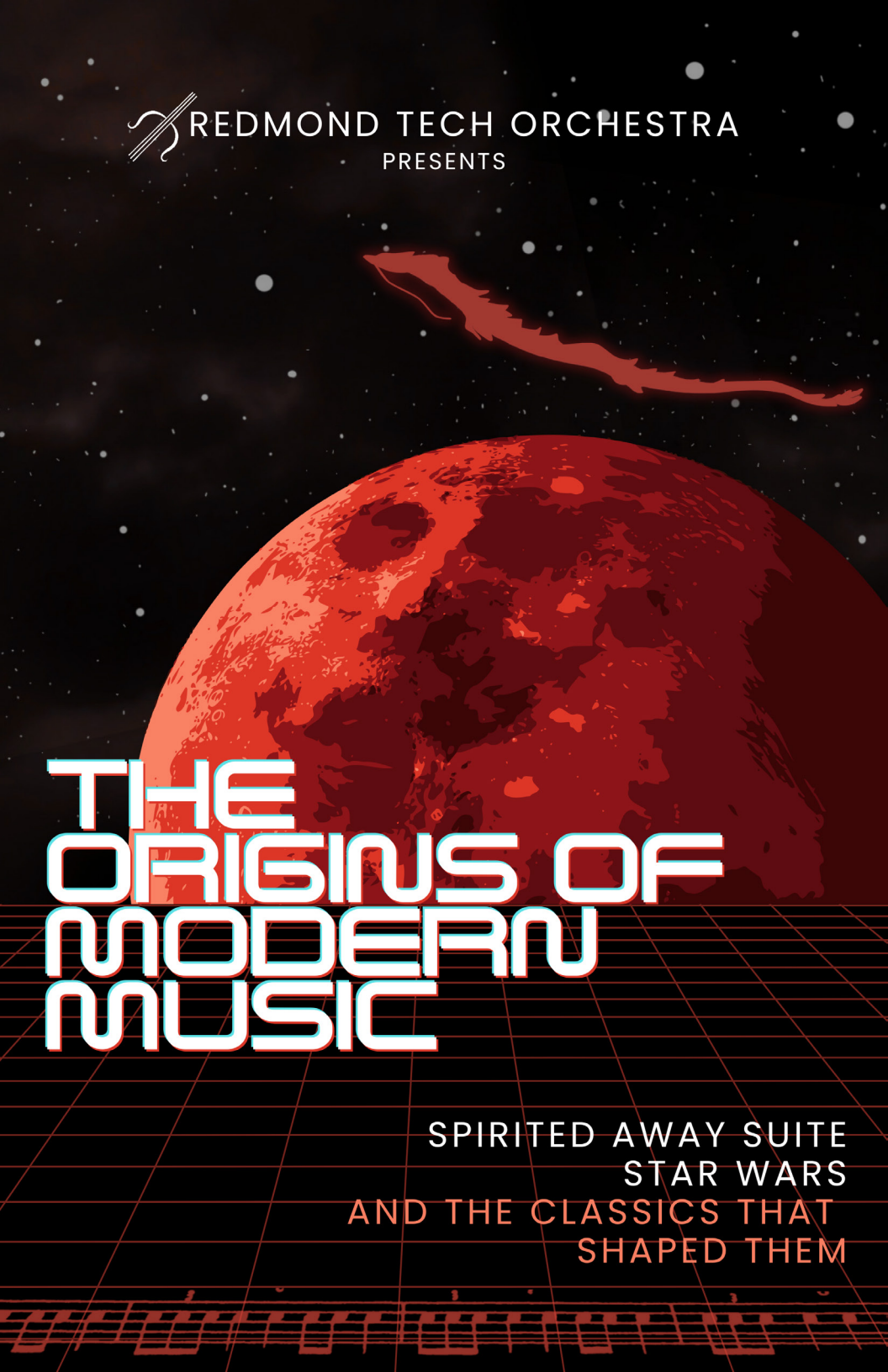

REDMOND TECH ORCHESTRA
PRESENTS
THE ORIGINS OF MODERN MUSIC
SPIRITED AWAY SUITE
STAR WARS
AND THE CLASSICS THAT SHAPED THEM

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TED WARNER
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Musician Roster

Violin I
Isabel Milewski
Concertmaster
Jerry He
Assistant principal
Anirudh Kumar
Audra Stump
Bryan Reich
Erica Choi
Eveline Bogdanski
Madeleine Jacobitz
Mayukha Ragimanu
Patrick Creighton
Rachel Keirouz
Ruying Sun
Sua Bae
William Sun

Violin II
Brandon Chen
Principal
Aditya Ramanathan
Assistant Principal
Amrutha Srikanth
Amy Ouyang
Andrea Lum
Farrah Hasen
Frederick Huyan
Michael Manansala
Michelle Ding
Peter Chow
Rachael Tang
Rodrigo Castaño
Sahana Srivatsan

Viola
Jacob Park
Principal
Eleanor Mengel
Assistant Principal
Anita Ambalavanan
Emily Price
Jayden Yu
Lauren Kam
Megan Jancola
Sumit Choudhury

Cello
Alaina Bossert
Co-Principal
Lotus Kam Chow
Co-Principal
Adrian Pang
Assistant Principal
Aleks Boljanac
Jason Dickens
Kevin Au
Nishita Manjunath
Sabrina Ang

Double Bass
Alex Hansen
Principal
Bonnie You
Supriya Dixit
Tanya Lai

Flute
Jennifer Lee
Alejandro Rios
Alex Ayala*
Britania Rodriguez Reyes
Erica Li
Hannah Bang
Martha Tran*
Nandhini Lakuduva*
Yoona Oh
Yueh Tsao

Piccolo
Alex Ayala*
Martha Tran*
Nandhini Lakuduva*

Oboe
Jennifer Williams
Ivan Romero Wells*
Rebecca Williams

English Horn
*Ivan Romero Wells**

Clarinet
David Chen
Emily You
*Vicky Harp**
Helen Xiong
Michael Taylor
Moe Tsuboike
Renee Hsu
Tom Glanz*

Bass Clarinet
Vicky Harp*
Tom Glanz*

Bassoon
Joshua Schnipke
Manuela Köpfli

Contrabassoon
Eric Shankland

Bari Saxophone
James Wilkinson

Horn
Andrew Schuck
Linda Brooking
Caeli MacLennan
Chris Haymond
Jon Dyer
Mark Hendrickson
Yuqing Wei

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Sven Boemer
Brooke Shendok
Ethan Wong
Melvin Pineda Miguel
Vyas Alwar

Trombone
Cole Brooking
Conall Anderson
Johnny Leek
Zach Neely*

Euphonium
Zach Neely*

Tuba
Adithya Subbiah

Timpani
Nicholas Vadasz
Chase Lee
Soo Stahl

Percussion
Matthew Kangas
Soo Stahl
Aaryaa Tiwari
Chase Lee
Enrique Saurez
Laurence Lu*
Nicholas Vadasz

Keyboard
Jada Campbell
Cori Belle
Laurence Lu*

Harp
Tamara Dobranic
Juliet Stratton

Conductor
Peter Yang

Italics denote principals
Asterisks (*) denote instrument doubling

Program

Samuel Barber	Violin Concerto, Op. 14 I. Allegro *Isabel Milewski, soloist*	11′
Gustav Holst	The Planets, Op. 32 I. Mars, the Bringer of War	8′
John Williams	Theme from *Star Wars*	7′
Erich Wolfgang Korngold	Kings Row Suite	7′
	— Intermission —	
Maurice Ravel	Valses nobles et sentimentales, M. 61a I. Modéré, très franc II. Assez lent, avec une expression intense VI. Vif VII. Moins vif	8′
Joe Hisaishi	Spirited Away Suite	25′

Violin Concerto, Mvt. 1 (Isabel Milewski, soloist)

Samuel Barber composed his Violin Concerto in 1939, as World War II loomed. In this performance, violin soloist Isabel Milewski brings its pensive lyricism and serious character to life. While atonality and twelve-tone technique gained prominence in the 1930s, Barber retained a more traditional, balanced introspection with rich, flowing expression. The concerto remains one of his most beloved works, second only to Adagio for Strings. Listen for the solo violin's opening melody, which unfolds across roughly two dozen measures with a flowing line and poignant harmonies; a simpler contrasting theme introduced by the clarinet and woven into the movement; and a brief accompanied cadenza that propels the Allegro to its close.

Mars from "The Planets"

Gustav Holst composed the entirety of *The Planets* between 1914 and 1917. Although The Planets reflects Holst's interest in astrology, the Sun and Earth are omitted because they are not visible as planets in the night sky. The movement that we are performing today, *Mars*, paints a vivid picture of war: its 5/4 *ostinato* begins quietly, then gathers force as dissonant harmonies, massive brass, heavy percussion, and strings played *col legno* evoke the machinery and devastation of modern warfare. A bleak, slower middle section paints a desolate landscape before the hammering opening theme returns, driving toward blunt final blows that offer destruction instead of glory. The suite as a whole later influenced cinematic music, most famously John Williams's Star Wars scores.

Star Wars Theme

John Williams composed the Star Wars: Main Title in 1977 for George Lucas's landmark space opera. Its opening fanfare bears a striking resemblance to Korngold's Kings Row main title, while its late-Romantic language also recalls Wagner, Holst, and Stravinsky. By the 1970s, the symphonic Hollywood score had fallen out of fashion, replaced by pop soundtracks and the rise of electronic music in film scoring, while science fiction in particular was associated with electronic and atonal sounds. Williams helped lead a revival of orchestral film scoring. He chose an emotionally familiar orchestra and a Wagnerian system of leitmotifs, where short musical snippets representing characters and concepts are used throughout the score. In the opening title alone, we are introduced to the musical themes of Luke Skywalker in the brass, the Rebel Alliance in the brass, and then winds, and finally Leia's theme with the cellos. The conflict between rebellion and empire reinforces Lucas's Vietnam-era allegory: a technologically superior power confronted by a determined, less powerful resistance.

Kings Row Suite

Few composers show the move from the concert hall to the film studio as clearly as Erich Wolfgang Korngold. Born in 1897 in Austria-Hungary, he was a famous child prodigy in Vienna. Gustav Mahler called him a genius, his ballet *Der Schneemann* was staged at the Vienna Court Opera when he was 13, and his opera *Die tote Stadt* (1920) was an international success by the time he was 23. While most film composers start out in commercial writing, Korngold came to Hollywood as an established European composer already having composed concert and opera works. In 1934, director Max Reinhardt invited him to adapt Mendelssohn's music for *A Midsummer Night's Dream*. As political conditions in Europe got worse, he spent more and more time in America. He was in Hollywood scoring *The Adventures of Robin Hood* in 1938 when Nazi Germany annexed Austria, and he did not go back. Exile turned a Viennese opera composer into one of the main architects of the Golden Age Hollywood sound, alongside Max Steiner. He brought the full symphonic tradition of late Romanticism to the screen.

Written for the 1942 Warner Bros. film adapted from Henry Bellamann's novel, *Kings Row Suite* distills Korngold's richly symphonic score into a compact musical drama. The film follows a group of children growing into adulthood in what seemed to be an idyllic Midwestern town whose surface conceals cruelty, scandal, and loss. The suite opens with a regal, brass-led main-title fanfare, then turns into a sparkling, playful variation associated with the innocence of childhood. This exuberant beginning initially suggests a noble adventure, but the story unfolds as a *Bildungsroman*: Korngold transforms and reconnects recurring themes as youthful optimism gives way to thwarted love, illness, betrayal, and tragedy. His large orchestra including expanded brass and woodwinds, percussion, piano, celesta, two harps, and strings, allows lyricism to erupt into sweeping climaxes, giving the music the continuity and emotional scale of an opera. As the drama darkens, the harmony and weight intensify before the triumphant opening fanfare returns, bringing the concert suite to a resolute close and affirming endurance after suffering. Korngold's description of his film scores as "operas without singing" is especially apt here: orchestral color and thematic development carry the narrative even without

the screen. The score's bold post-Romantic language helped define Hollywood's symphonic style and later generations of film composers.

Valses nobles et sentimentales

Maurice Ravel was a prominent figure of French Impressionism, an artistic movement focused on capturing fleeting sensory impressions, mood, and atmospheric color rather than strict narrative or formal structures. His music embodies these qualities through rich tone colors and harmonic ambiguity. Franz Schubert, a prolific waltz composer, inspired Ravel's 1911 set, whose title echoes Schubert's Valses sentimentales (1823) and Valses nobles (1826) to signal his aim to write "Schubertian waltzes." Originally composed for piano and orchestrated in 1912, the set comprises seven waltzes and an epilogue. Tonight, we perform a selection of four waltzes: 1, 2, 6, and 7.

Movement 1: *Modéré*, très franc (Moderate, very frank). Bold, brash harmonies and chromatic turns establish a confident "noble" character over a crisp waltz pulse. At the work's anonymous premiere, this striking opening famously shocked the audience.

Movement 2: *Assez lent, avec une expression intense* (Fairly slow, with intense expression). The mood turns inward and tender, revealing the "sentimental" side of the set through lyrical lines, lingering suspensions, and warm, atmospheric harmonies.

Movement 6: *Vif* (Lively). Brisk and propulsive, this waltz sheds the earlier introspection for sparkling rhythms, crisp accents, and swift, dance-like momentum.

Movement 7: *Moins vif* (Less lively). Dreamy and gently melancholic, the final selection relaxes the preceding dance into a *languissant* close, with a delicate singing melody—*le chant en dehors*—floating above shimmering, bittersweet harmonies.

Spirited Away Suite

Joe Hisaishi's musical style bridges Western classical traditions and modern aesthetics. He started out in the 1970s writing minimalist music, influenced by American composers such as Philip Glass, Steve Reich, and Terry Riley. While his concert works frequently incorporate minimalism and rhythmic repetition, his film scores, especially from his decades-long partnership with director Hayao Miyazaki, combine that rhythmic drive with broad, singable melodies and a lyricism close to late Romanticism. A hallmark of Hisaishi's harmonic language is his use of quartal harmony (chords built on fourths rather than traditional thirds), a defining feature of Japanese orchestral composition that we can also find in today's selection of music, including Barber.

Hisaishi reconstructed and reorchestrated his original soundtrack for Miyazaki's *Spirited Away* as a unified concert suite that traces the film's dramatic arc. The music follows Chihiro's journey into a mysterious spirit realm, where her name is changed to Sen, her parents are transformed into pigs, and a series of trials leads

her toward courage, identity, and a path home. The ten movements are *One Summer's Day (Inochi no Namae)*, with its gentle piano-led opening; *Nighttime Coming; The Gods; View of the Morning; The Bottomless Pit,* with its intense, aggressive scoring; *The Dragon Boy; No Face*, built around the No-Face (Kaonashi) motif; *The Sixth Station (Rokueki),* portraying the quiet, liminal train stop between the real world and the underworld; *Reprise*; and *The Return*. The suite contrasts forceful and unsettling episodes with moments of stillness—especially *The Sixth Station,* whose atmosphere evokes reflections on passage, memory, and the feelings of being alive.

Program notes by Sabrina Ang
Cover/poster design by Taylor Thackaberry
Program design by Taylor Thackaberry



Isabel Milewski — Soloist

Huiting Isabel Milewski has spent much of her life pursuing two passions: violin and technology. She holds a Master's degree in Violin Performance and a Bachelor's degree in Computer Science, and has served as Concertmaster of the Redmond Tech Orchestra for the past two years since joining the orchestra in 2024.

Beyond the concert stage, Isabel is a Senior Software Engineering Lead at Microsoft and an instructor in Applied Agentic AI at Interview Kickstart. She treasures RTO for giving her the rare opportunity to bring her musical and technical worlds together, and to make music alongside a community that shares both passions.

Our Mascot



Moomie's musical journey began on the farms of Carnation, WA, when she started learning cowbell at just three months old. Her musical talents brought her to the Redmond Tech Orchestra where she happily spends her days enjoying soft classical music, munching on organic grass and grains, and being loved by the members of the orchestra.

In her spare time, Moomie loves to explore the Puget Sound and to find new friends to share her love of music. Her all-time favorite composers are Brahms and Ravel, and she loves Saint-Saëns' *Carnival of the Animals*, which has so many references to her animal friends! Moomie's excited to meet you all and see you at our future concerts.

Upcoming Concerts

Join us at the Redmond Performing Arts Center **April 1st at 7pm** and **April 3rd at 4pm** for an evening inspired by one of music's most enigmatic masterpieces. Tchaikovsky's *Symphony No. 6, Pathétique* stands as a deeply human meditation on longing, love, struggle, triumph, and loss, and though the composer hinted at a hidden program, he refused to reveal its meaning. Through a carefully curated journey of works that echo its themes and emotional landscapes, this concert invites each listener to discover their own answer to the riddle that has captivated audiences for more than a century.

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As a nonprofit organization, the Redmond Tech Orchestra relies on your generous donations to continue bringing music to the community. Your support helps us organize events and foster a love for music in the greater Redmond area. Please consider donating to help us keep the music alive. Every contribution, no matter the size, makes a significant impact.

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